What made Prof. Sarabhai pick a few of us for this great mission? One reason seemed to be our professional background. Dr Gowarikar was doing outstanding work in the field of composite propel ants. MR Kurup had established an excel ent laboratory for propel ants, propulsion and pyrotechnics. Muthunayagam had proved himself in the field of high energy propel ants. The fourth stage was to be a composite structure and cal ed for a large number of innovations in fabrication technology; perhaps that was why I was brought in.

I laid the foundation for Stage IV on two rocks—sensible approximation and unawed support. I have always considered the price of perfection prohibitive and al owed mistakes as a part of the learning process. I prefer a dash of daring and persistence to perfection. I have always supported learning on the part of my team members by paying vigilant attention to each of their attempts, be they successful or unsuccessful.

In my group, progress was recognized and reinforced at every tiny step. Although I provided access to al the information that my co-workers in Stage IV needed, I found I could not spend enough time to be a useful facilitator and a